DraftKings

Business Development Dossier

Industry	**Technology / Online Gaming**
Revenue	**$6.7B**
Employees	**5,500**
Ideal Customer Profile Score	**82**

ICP SCORING MODEL


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ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit   (max 100)
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Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% | <90d: 30% | <180d: 20% | older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	$500M-$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below $500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 | Above $10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) | 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 19, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	DraftKings Inc.
Headquarters	Boston, Massachusetts
Founded	2011
Ownership	Public (NASDAQ: DKNG)

Footprint

Sportsbook in 30 U.S. states + DC + Ontario + Puerto Rico. Predictions in 38 states. Operations span 13 countries.

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

DraftKings is a digital sports entertainment and gaming company operating one of the largest online sportsbooks and daily fantasy sports platforms in North America. The company went public via SPAC in 2020 and has rapidly expanded into mobile sports betting as states legalize.

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding DraftKings's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

Revenue: FY2023 $3.67B -> FY2025 $6.06B (+27%) -> FY2026E $6.5-6.9B. First profitable year in FY2025. Q4 net income $136.4M. Adj. EBITDA $620M (+242%). Consensus Buy (27 buy, 8 hold). Pressures: G&A grew from 6% to 22% of revenue; state tax escalation; surcharge debacle. Tailwinds: $10B prediction markets TAM; Jackpocket $340M revenue contribution; AI cost reduction.

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Jason Robins - Co-Founder, CEO & Chairman [PRIORITY TARGET]

Duke (Government). Capital One, Vistaprint. 2025 C-Suite Executive of the Year.

Outreach rationale: Ultimate economic buyer navigating company's most complex transformation.

Jason Park - Chief Transformation Officer [PRIORITY TARGET]

11 years PE Operating Partner. Oversaw IPO and growth from $323M to $3.7B as CFO.

Outreach rationale: Entire role is transformation. PE background = speaks value creation language. Directly owns cross-functional integration.

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Alan Ellingson - Chief Financial Officer

Linda Aiello - Chief People Officer
Previously CPO at Qurate, Stitch Fix; senior HR at Salesforce, Uber, LVMH

Paul Liberman - Co-Founder, President (Global Tech & Product)

Matthew Kalish - Co-Founder, President (North America)

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how DraftKings operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

Three co-founders still operationally active. Multiple verticals (Sportsbook, Casino, DFS, Lottery, Predictions) being consolidated into Super App.

Culture Signals

Glassdoor 3.9/5 (71% recommend). Career opportunities 3.7 (lowest). Negatives: favoritism, constant reshuffling, 24/7 expectations, marketing analytics 30-40% attrition. Culture described as 'great if you like sports and can hang with the guys.' Silo risk extreme: four verticals forced into single Super App with different regulatory environments.

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging DraftKings.

1. **2026-02-25 - ~5% workforce reduction across 13 countries; second layoffs in three years**
   Organizational trauma during transformation. McChrystal's high-stakes transition expertise directly applicable.
2. **2026-03-02 - Investor Day: Super App strategy, $10B prediction markets, $55-80B 2030 TAM**
   Four verticals into one platform requires cross-functional alignment and shared consciousness.
3. **2026-02-12 - Q4/FY2025: first profitable year but conservative guidance triggered 13% selloff**
   Investor pressure + growth deceleration. Leadership under pressure.
4. **2025-12-19 - DraftKings Predictions launched in 38 states under CFTC regulation**
   New regulatory paradigm requires organizational adaptation.
5. **2024-05-01 - Jason Park moved from CFO to newly created CTO role**

Explicit transformation mandate - entry point for McChrystal.

6. **2024-08-14 - Gaming surcharge announced then reversed within days after backlash**
   Reveals gaps in stakeholder analysis and decision-making.

7. **2024-05-23 - Completed $750M Jackpocket acquisition**
   Post-acquisition integration challenge.

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

> *Every ICP signal - $6B+ revenue, 5K+ employees, dedicated CTO role, multi-vector disruption, acquisition integration. Squarely in sweet spot.*

Primary Problem

Simultaneous multi-vector transformation: Super App integration, $750M acquisition, new regulatory domain (CFTC), AI workforce replacement, restructuring - all while shifting from growth-at-all-costs to profitability.

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Team of Teams - Super App demands shared consciousness across four verticals. Also: org design (CTO needs frameworks), leadership development (scaling founder leadership), culture change (layoffs + Glassdoor signals).

Likely Objections to Engagement

Already have a CTO - handling internally
Tech company needs tech consultants
Margins under pressure
No military DNA

Competitive Advisory Landscape

McKinsey/BCG/Bain - org design
Accenture - AI implementation
Korn Ferry - leadership
McChrystal differentiator: VUCA framework + Team of Teams for structural integration problems

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. You created a Chief Transformation Officer role - what does Jason Park's mandate look like day-to-day, and where is the integration across Sportsbook, Predictions, Casino, and Lottery proving harder than expected?

2. Your Super App requires four product teams under different regulatory frameworks to share a single customer experience. How are you building shared consciousness across them without slowing any down?

3. Two rounds of layoffs in three years while asking the org to take on prediction markets, integrate Jackpocket, and launch a Super App. How are you maintaining trust and talent retention?

Recommended Meeting Framing

Position as 'transformation operating model' conversation. Lead with Team of Teams applied to Super App integration. Avoid military metaphors initially. Jason Park (CTO) = ideal first meeting; Robins (CEO) = the close.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects DraftKings's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

Brand Value & Competitive Standing: DraftKings is the #2 U.S. online sportsbook behind FanDuel, with ~30% market share in a rapidly growing $30B+ U.S. market. The brand is synonymous with daily fantasy sports (its origin) and increasingly with mainstream sports betting. Brand awareness is high among 21-45 male sports fans but the brand competes intensely with FanDuel, BetMGM, and ESPN Bet for customer acquisition.

Brand Identity Evolution: DraftKings is pivoting from "sports betting company" to "digital sports entertainment platform" - the Super App vision combines sportsbook, DFS, casino, prediction markets, and media into a single experience. This brand evolution requires organizational coordination across product lines that historically operated independently.

Marketing Leadership & Strategy: DraftKings is one of the largest sports marketing spenders in the U.S. - major sponsorships with NFL, NBA, MLB, NHL, UFC, and individual teams. Marketing spend has been aggressive (customer acquisition costs are a key investor concern). The shift toward profitability means marketing must become more efficient without losing market share.

Brand Threats: ESPN Bet (Disney/Penn Entertainment) brings massive brand equity to sports betting. Fanatics Sportsbook leverages 80M+ loyalty members. State-level regulatory changes could restrict advertising. Brand reputation risks from problem gambling associations.

Major Brand Investments: Stadium naming rights, league-level partnerships, celebrity endorsements (e.g., Kevin Hart), and significant digital marketing spend. The prediction market entry (DraftKings Markets) extends the brand into a new category.

McChrystal Connection: The Super App vision requires every product line (sportsbook, DFS, casino, prediction markets) to deliver a seamless experience - but they were built as separate products with separate teams. The brand promise of a unified entertainment platform demands organizational coordination that doesn't yet exist. McChrystal's cross-functional alignment ensures the Super App experience matches the brand promise.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing DraftKings. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: Super App Integration as Organizational Challenge

DraftKings' Super App combines 4+ product lines (sportsbook, DFS, casino, prediction markets) into a unified experience. Each product has its own engineering team, regulatory requirements, P&L, and culture. McKinsey can design the Super App strategy; McChrystal builds the cross-product coordination system that makes the integrated experience actually work. Competitor displacement: Accenture builds the technology integration; McChrystal ensures the teams behind the technology coordinate at the speed sports entertainment demands.

Fit Dimension 2: Multi-Country Restructuring During Growth

Restructuring across 13 countries while simultaneously launching new products (prediction markets) and integrating acquisitions ($750M Jackpocket) requires organizational coordination that traditional consulting can't deliver at the required speed. McChrystal's operating rhythm manages parallel transformation workstreams without slowing product velocity.

Fit Dimension 3: Regulatory Complexity as Coordination Challenge

Operating in 25+ states with different regulatory frameworks, plus CFTC regulation for prediction markets, requires cross-functional coordination between legal, compliance, product, engineering, and operations. Each new state or product launch is a mini-integration project. McChrystal's Team of Teams approach scales this coordination.

9b. Cumulative Case - Why DraftKings Is a Top Pipeline Opportunity

DraftKings is the fastest-moving company in the pipeline - launching new products, integrating acquisitions, and restructuring simultaneously, all in a hyper-competitive market where speed determines market share. Signal chain: Earnings miss -> restructuring across 13 countries -> Super App launch -> prediction market entry (new regulatory regime) -> $750M Jackpocket integration -> all while FanDuel and ESPN Bet compete for every customer. Revenue potential: $400K-$500K initial engagement (Super App coordination architecture), $1M-$1.5M deployment, $300K-$500K ongoing. Total: $1.5M-$2.5M over 18 months.

9c. Enterprise Issues & Organizational Challenges

1. Super App Product Coordination: Four product lines with separate engineering teams, roadmaps, and release cycles must deliver a seamless unified experience. Without coordination, the Super App becomes four apps with a shared login.

2. Restructuring While Launching: Laying off employees across 13 countries while simultaneously launching prediction markets and integrating Jackpocket creates organizational whiplash - survivors wonder if they're next while being asked to deliver more.

3. Acquisition Integration Under Time Pressure: Jackpocket's lottery technology must integrate with DraftKings' platform before competitors close the gap. Integration velocity matters more than integration perfection.

4. Regulatory Multi-Threading: CFTC (prediction markets), state gaming commissions (sports betting), and international regulators each have different requirements. Product launches must navigate this complexity without slowing to a crawl.

5. Profitability Pivot Culture Clash: DraftKings' growth-at-all-costs culture must shift to disciplined profitability - a fundamental cultural transformation that affects every team's incentives, metrics, and decision-making.

6. Chief Transformation Officer Signal: The creation of a CTO role (Jason Park) signals leadership knows coordination is the bottleneck. This person is a natural McChrystal champion.

9d. Expected Outcomes from McChrystal Group Engagement

1. Super App Coordination Architecture: Cross-product operating rhythm connecting sportsbook, DFS, casino, and prediction market teams. Measurable: unified release cadence with <5% cross-product conflicts.

2. Restructuring + Launch Coordination: Parallel workstream management preventing restructuring from slowing product launches. Measurable: prediction market launch timeline maintained within 2 weeks of target.

3. Acquisition Integration Velocity: Jackpocket integration cadence hitting milestones on schedule. Measurable: integration milestones on-track within 90 days.

4. Regulatory Navigation Speed: Cross-functional coordination for state-by-state and product-specific regulatory compliance. Measurable: regulatory approval timelines reduced by 20%.

5. Profitability Culture Transition: Operating discipline framework supporting the shift from growth-first to profitable growth. Measurable: cost-per-acquisition targets achieved across all product lines.

9e. Key Stakeholders & Business Unit Map

CEO / Co-Founder

Leader: Jason Robins
Function: Enterprise strategy, vision
McChrystal Relevance: Executive sponsor

Transformation Office

Leader: Jason Park, CTO
Function: Cross-functional coordination
McChrystal Relevance: Priority: Super App integration, restructuring

Finance

Leader: Alan Ellingson, CFO
Function: Profitability pivot, cost management
McChrystal Relevance: Budget gatekeeper

People

Leader: Linda Aiello, CPO
Function: Restructuring, culture transition
McChrystal Relevance: Change management

Product & Tech

Leader: Paul Liberman, President
Function: Super App development, engineering
McChrystal Relevance: Technology coordination

North America

Leader: Matthew Kalish, President
Function: Market operations, state expansion
McChrystal Relevance: Regulatory coordination

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Strategic Signal Convergence - Why Now: Earnings miss -> restructuring -> Super App launch -> prediction market entry -> Jackpocket integration -> profitability pivot. Everything is happening simultaneously. The CTO role creation signals internal acknowledgment that coordination is the bottleneck.

The Structural Paradox - Why McChrystal, Not McKinsey: McKinsey advises on market strategy. Accenture builds the technology platform. But the challenge is coordinating 5+ simultaneous transformation initiatives (restructuring, Super App, prediction markets, acquisition, profitability pivot) at the speed the competitive market demands. McChrystal builds the coordination architecture that lets everything move in parallel.

Phased Engagement Hypothesis:

- Phase 1 ($400K-$500K, 3 months): Super App coordination architecture - cross-product operating rhythm, restructuring/launch parallel management.
- Phase 2 ($700K-$1M, 6 months): Enterprise deployment across all product lines and geographies.
- Phase 3 ($300K-$500K retainer): Ongoing coordination management through profitability transition.

Multi-Threaded Pursuit Map:

- Thread 1: Jason Park (CTO) - transformation coordination. Angle: "Your role was created because coordination is the bottleneck. McChrystal builds the operating system for multi-front transformation."
- Thread 2: Linda Aiello (CPO) - restructuring + culture. Angle: "How do you restructure across 13 countries while launching new products without destroying morale?"
- Thread 3: Jason Robins (CEO) via sports/entertainment network - executive sponsor. McChrystal's military brand resonates in the competitive, high-intensity gaming culture.